SUMMARY.

The Scotch express on the North-Eastern railway collided with a goods train near Thirsk Junction, Yorkshire, early on Wednesday morning. Nine passengers were killed and 50 injured.

After the Scotch express had been wrecked by collision on Wednesday the debris caught fire, and two injured passengers were roasted to death before they could be extricated.

Among those killed in the railway collision in England on Wednesday was Captain R. W. Macleod, of the Queen's Own Cameron Highlanders, who was journeying to London to catch a steamer for Australia.

The railway accident in England on Wednesday is said to be due to the great pressure of traffic on the line

The Belgian Chamber of Representatives has rejected a proposal for the introduction of universal suffrage.

Sir James F. Garrick, writing to *The Times*, says that the Queensland Government are anxious to give provincial government to the north, and expect to be able to do so before long.

The *Pioneer of India* says that Colonel Yanoff, the leader of the Russian expedition in the Pamirs, deliberately picked the quarrel with the Afghans.

The Chinese army at Kashgar is being dispersed, as the Russian forces have retired into winter quarters.

Mr. John Burns, M.P., says that he is satisfied with the progress socialism has made in England. He thinks the time has arrived for a constructive policy.

M. Loubet, the French Premier, has declined to anpoint French bishops at the bidding of the Pope.

The annual meeting of shareholders in the Eastern Extension Telegraph Company was held in London on Wednesday.

Sir John Pender, M.P., expects that the people of Queensland will yet compel the Government of that colony to participate in the reduced cable rates.

Sir Henry B. Loch, who is in London on official business, was banqueted on Wednesday night.

The Secretary of State for the Colonies says that the Government are keenly alive to the importance of colonial interests, and are closely watching the commercial relations between Great Britain and her colonies.

A meeting of the Imperial Federation League is to be held on the 16th inst., to consider the suggested colonial conference on defence matters.

The Imperial Postmaster-General persists in his refusal to renew the British subsidy to the Pacific mail service.

It is officially denied in London that Sir Robert Hamilton, Governor of Tasmania, is returning to England to draft the Irish Home Rule Bill.

The appointment of Sir Robert Hamilton's successor as Governor of Tasmania is to be made early next year.

The French Government have pardoned the coal-miners at Carmaux who were convicted of strike riots.

The *New York Tribune* says that the Democratic party have command of an enormous corruption fund for use in the presidential election.

Mr. Barbour, one of the directors of the Midland Railway Company of West Australia, says that the Government of that colony find that they made a bad bargain with the company, and wish to wriggle out of their engagements.

Lieutenant Peary, who recently explored Greenland, says that the ice is of sufficient thickness to admit of railways being constructed over it.

The London Committee of the North Queensland Separation League are awaiting further advices before urging the Imperial Government to take action for the separation of the colony.

The Bathurst Municipal Council has placed £20,000 worth of 5 per cent. debentures upon the London market, with a minimum of 99.

Bar silver has declined in London to 3s 3¼d per ounce.

Mr. Justice Windeyer summed up yesterday at the Central Criminal Court in the charges of conspiracy against officials of the Australian Banking Company. The jury, after an absence of nearly three hours, found M'Namara and Abigail guilty, and acquitted Salmon and Twist.

At the Central Criminal Court yesterday Mr. Justice Windeyer sentenced Roderick M'Namara to seven years' hard labor and Francis Abigail, who had been strongly recommended to mercy by the jury, to five years' hard labor.

In the Assembly last night Sir George Dibbs said that if time permitted a bill would be introduced this session dealing with factories and workshops.

The second reading of the Employers' Liability Act Amendment Bill was moved in the Legislative Council last night. The debate was adjourned for a week.

Jacob Molez, alias "Dr. Besant," was yesterday committed for trial charged with using an instrument on Elizabeth Gray with intent.

During the first six months of this year 705 inquests were held throughout the colony. In 267 cases post'mortem examinations were held.

A fire has occurred in a coalpit at the Heath, Brunnerton (N.Z.), but the extent of the damage done has not yet been ascertained.

The first dividend in connection with the Mercantile Bank of Australia was payable yesterday. It is at the rate of 2s 6d in the £, and will absorb £197,000.

The Minister for Works yesterday promised to consider a proposal for the extension of the Balmain tramway by cable from Gladstone Park to the foot of Darling-street.

The bodies of five infants have been discovered buried in a yard at the back of a house, 25 Burren-street, Macdonaldtown. Four persons have been arrested on suspicion.

The Assembly, on its rising last night, adjourned to Thursday next, Wednesday being the Prince of Wales' Birthday and a public holiday.

A Supply Bill for £101,000 was carried through all its stages in the Assembly last night.

Cardinal Moran yesterday opened a village fair at Camperdown in aid of the building fund of the local Roman Catholic Church.

The collision between the Scotch express and a goods train was caused by a signalman being asleep. He had applied to be relieved from duty, as he had passed the previous night watching a dying child.

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Mr. Black, M.P., says that the Government is the tool of an infamous conspiracy which exists for the putting down of trades-unionism.

From January 31 to October 31 the Treasury received the sum of £142,068 on account of auction sales of land.

The V.R.C. spring meeting was continued yesterday, when the events resulted as follow:—Flying Stakes, Bungebah; Second Hurdle Race, Pingara; Spring Handicap, Titan; Royal Park Stakes, Donation; and Veteran Stakes Handicap, Litigant.

The principal event at the V.R.C. spring meeting yesterday was the Oaks, which was won by Mr. H. Power's Etra Weenie, Trieste being second, and Insomnia third.

During the quarter ended September 30 the revenue from passenger and goods traffic on the railways amounted to £705,351 as compared with £721,343 in the same quarter last year.

The tramway revenue during the quarter ended September 30 amounted to £71,414 and the expenditure to £42,843.

The four-masted barque Ranee Rickmers left the harbor yesterday for Singapore, with 3221 tons of coal.

A magnificent supply of artesian water has been struck at Cuttabulla station, near Bourke, the daily outflow being estimated at 4,000,000 gallons.

A bill to amend the Probate Act was introduced into the Legislative Council last night by Mr. R. E. O'Connor. The amendments are of a technical character.

A meeting of citizens was held in the Protestant hall last night, at which resolutions were carried condemning the sentences passed upon the Broken-hill strike leaders as cruel, unjust, unjustifiable and a direct blow to the liberty of the subject.

The steamer Sikh arrived in Port Jackson last evening from Hongkong via ports.

The Orient liner Oroya sails from Melbourne for Sydney to-morrow.